

DATASYNC TECHNOLOGIES PVT. LTD.

EMPLOYEE & TECHNOLOGY POLICY HANDBOOK

Company Policies, Data Governance & Generative AI Usage Standards

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THIS HANDBOOK AT A GLANCE

Policy Area	Key Number
Remote work (post-probation)	Up to 3 days/week
Internet reimbursement	₹1,200/month
Learning reimbursement	₹8,000/year
Performance reviews	June & December
Expense submission window	15 days
Manager approval threshold	Purchases above ₹25,000
Security incident reporting	Within 24 hours
Core collaboration hours	10 AM – 4 PM IST

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Need Help? Key Contacts

Topic	Contact
General HR queries	HR Portal / People Operations
Security incidents (report within 24 hrs)	security@datasync-tech.example
Data privacy requests	privacy@datasync-tech.example
Ethics & grievance reporting	Anonymous Ethics Hotline
Policy feedback & suggestions	policy-feedback@datasync-tech.example

01 COMPANY OVERVIEW

Who we are, what we build, and the principles that guide us

DataSync Technologies Pvt. Ltd. ("DataSync", "the Company", "we", or "us") is a technology company building enterprise data platforms, integration tools, and applied artificial intelligence products for customers across financial services, healthcare, retail, and the public sector. Headquartered in Coimbatore, India, DataSync operates regional delivery centers and a distributed remote workforce across multiple countries.

This Employee & Technology Policy Handbook ("the Handbook") is the single point of reference for how we work together, how we treat one another, and how we use technology — including generative AI and retrieval-augmented systems — that sits at the center of our daily work. It applies to every employee, intern, contractor, and consultant engaged by DataSync, unless a specific policy states otherwise.

Our Mission

To help organizations synchronize their data, decisions, and teams — by building software and AI systems that are accurate, explainable, and safe to rely on.

Our Values

- Integrity first — we tell customers and colleagues the truth, even when it is inconvenient.
- Craft over shortcuts — we take pride in the quality of what we ship.
- Curiosity as a habit — we stay students of our own field.
- Respect by default — we assume good intent and communicate accordingly.
- Ownership — everyone is accountable for outcomes, not just tasks.

How This Handbook Works

Each section of this Handbook stands on its own and is updated independently as regulations, tools, or business needs evolve. Employees are expected to read this Handbook in full within thirty (30) days of joining and to acknowledge that they have done so via the HR portal.

This document supersedes all previous versions of the Employee Handbook. Where local law provides greater employee protection than a policy described here, local law prevails.

Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Employee	Read the Handbook and complete the onboarding acknowledgment
Manager	Reinforce Company values in day-to-day team practice
People Operations	Maintain and update the Handbook as policies evolve

Example: A new hire completes the Handbook acknowledgment on the HR portal within their first week and raises a clarifying question about the Code of Conduct to their manager.

Common Pitfalls to Avoid

- Assuming the Handbook doesn't apply because you're a contractor or intern

- Skipping the onboarding acknowledgment on the HR portal
- Relying on an outdated printed copy instead of the HR portal version

02 WORKING HOURS

Core hours, scheduling, attendance, and overtime

DataSync operates on a standard workweek of 40 hours, Monday through Friday. Outside of core hours, teams may agree on flexible start and end times that suit their working style, provided deliverables and meeting commitments are met.

KEY FACT Core collaboration hours are 10:00 AM – 4:00 PM IST, during which all employees must be reachable for meetings and urgent requests, regardless of location.

Standard Schedule

Employee Category	Standard Hours	Core Hours
Full-time office-based	9:00 AM – 6:00 PM IST	10:00 AM – 4:00 PM IST
Full-time remote	Flexible, 8 hrs/day	10:00 AM – 4:00 PM IST
Shift-based support staff	As per roster	As per roster
Interns	9:30 AM – 5:30 PM IST	10:00 AM – 4:00 PM IST

Attendance & Time Tracking

All employees log attendance through the internal Time & Attendance system daily. Repeated unexplained absence from core hours without prior communication to a manager is addressed through the performance management process in Section 14.

Overtime

Overtime applies only to employees classified as non-exempt under applicable local labor law and must be pre-approved by a manager. Overtime is compensated at 1.5x the standard hourly rate, or through compensatory time off where locally permitted.

Public Holidays

DataSync observes the statutory public holidays of the country in which an employee is contractually based, published each December for the following calendar year. Employees may substitute up to two floating holidays per year with manager approval.

Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Employee	Log attendance daily and flag schedule conflicts early
Manager	Approve flexible schedules and monitor core-hour reachability
People Operations	Publish the annual holiday calendar each December

Example: An employee based in a different time zone shifts their start time to 7 AM local so their 10 AM – 4 PM IST core hours still align with the rest of the team.

Common Pitfalls to Avoid

- Being unreachable during the 10 AM – 4 PM IST core hours without notice
- Logging attendance inconsistently across the week
- Assuming overtime is automatic without manager pre-approval

03 REMOTE WORK POLICY

Working from home, hybrid arrangements, and equipment

DataSync supports a hybrid-first working model. Employees whose roles do not require physical presence may work remotely, subject to team-level agreements set by their manager and function head.

KEY FACT Remote work is capped at a maximum of 3 days per week once an employee has completed probation. Employees who are still on probation are expected to work on-site full time unless their offer letter states otherwise.

Eligibility

- Employees who have completed their probation period (typically 90 days).
- Roles not designated as "on-site required" by the department head.
- Employees based in a country where DataSync has a registered legal entity or approved remote-work arrangement.

Home Office Requirements

Remote employees must maintain a dedicated, reasonably quiet workspace with a stable internet connection of at least 20 Mbps, and must ensure confidential screens and conversations are not visible or audible to unauthorized household members or visitors. Company-issued laptops must be used for all work involving customer data.

International Remote Work

Employees wishing to work remotely from a country other than their contracted country of employment for more than 15 consecutive calendar days must submit a Cross-Border Remote Work Request to People Operations at least three weeks in advance, so tax, immigration, and data residency implications can be reviewed.

Equipment & Reimbursement

DataSync provides a laptop, a headset, and a one-time home-office setup allowance to eligible remote employees, as detailed in Section 6. Equipment remains Company property and must be returned upon exit per Section 22.

Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Employee	Confirm eligibility before adopting a remote schedule
Manager	Set team-level remote-work norms within policy limits

Role	Responsibility
IT	Provision secure remote access and enforce device requirements

Example: After completing probation, an engineer arranges to work from home on Mondays, Wednesdays, and Fridays, staying within the 3-day-per-week cap.

Common Pitfalls to Avoid

- Working remotely more than 3 days/week without an approved exception
- Skipping the Cross-Border Remote Work Request before working abroad
- Using a personal device to access customer data

04 LEAVE POLICY

Annual leave, sick leave, parental leave, and other absences

DataSync provides a structured leave program designed to give employees time to rest, recover, and manage life events, while ensuring predictable coverage for teams and customers.

Leave Entitlements

Leave Type	Entitlement	Notes
Annual/Earned Leave	24 days/year	Accrued monthly; carry-forward up to 10 days
Sick Leave	12 days/year	Medical certificate required beyond 2 consecutive days
Casual Leave	6 days/year	For short-notice personal matters
Maternity Leave	26 weeks	As per statutory requirement, paid
Paternity Leave	15 days	Within 6 months of childbirth/adoption
Bereavement Leave	5 days	Immediate family; 2 days for extended family
Marriage Leave	5 days	Once per employment, own wedding

Requesting Leave

All leave must be requested through the HR portal in advance, except in emergencies where the employee should inform their manager as soon as reasonably possible and file the request retroactively.

Unpaid Leave

Employees who have exhausted their paid leave balance may request unpaid leave of up to 30 days per year, subject to manager and HR Business Partner approval.

Leave During Notice Period

Leave requests submitted during an active resignation notice period (Section 21) are subject to business needs and may be limited to ensure adequate knowledge transfer.

Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Employee	Submit leave requests through the HR portal in advance
Manager	Review and approve leave considering team coverage
HR	Track balances and process statutory leave correctly

Example: An employee planning a two-week trip submits the leave request three weeks ahead so their manager can plan coverage.

Common Pitfalls to Avoid

- Requesting long leave with less than two weeks' notice
- Assuming casual leave carries forward like earned leave
- Not informing the manager promptly in a genuine emergency

05 EMPLOYEE BENEFITS

Health, wellness, financial, and lifestyle benefits

DataSync offers a comprehensive benefits package intended to support employees' physical health, financial security, and long-term growth. Specific benefit values are detailed in the annual Total Rewards Statement issued to each employee.

Health & Insurance

- Group Medical Insurance covering the employee, spouse, and up to two dependent children.
- Group Personal Accident and Term Life Insurance at no cost to the employee.
- Annual health check-up voucher for employees above 30 years of age.
- Employee Assistance Program (EAP) offering confidential counseling sessions.

Financial Benefits

- Provident Fund / retirement contributions as per local statutory schemes.
- Performance-linked annual bonus, reviewed each fiscal year.
- Employee referral bonus for successful hires through the referral program.
- Relocation assistance for employees moving cities for a Company-initiated transfer.

Wellness & Lifestyle

- Subsidized gym and fitness app memberships.
- Learning stipend as detailed in Section 15.
- Childcare reimbursement support for employees with children under six years.
- Company-sponsored team events, festival celebrations, and an annual offsite.

Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Employee	Enroll in benefits during the annual open-enrollment window
HR	Administer insurance, EAP, and financial benefit programs
Finance	Process employer contributions on schedule

Example: An employee adds a newborn to their group medical insurance within the 30-day window following childbirth.

Common Pitfalls to Avoid

- Missing the annual open-enrollment window for benefit changes
- Assuming all benefits are identical across every country of employment
- Not updating dependent details after a life event

06 EXPENSE REIMBURSEMENT

Business travel, home office, and client-related expenses

DataSync reimburses reasonable, pre-approved business expenses incurred in the course of an employee's duties.

KEY FACT Expense claims must be submitted through the Expense Management System within 15 days of the expense being incurred, accompanied by an itemized receipt. Claims submitted after this window may be declined.

KEY FACT Internet reimbursement for eligible remote employees is capped at ₹1,200 per month and is credited automatically along with monthly payroll on submission of a valid bill.

KEY FACT Any purchase above ₹25,000 — including software licenses, hardware, or vendor services — requires prior manager approval regardless of department or budget availability.

Categories of Reimbursable Expense

Category	Approval Needed	Typical Limit
Domestic travel (train/flight)	Manager pre-approval	Economy class
International travel	Director pre-approval	Economy/Premium Economy
Client meals & entertainment	Manager pre-approval	As per role-based cap
Home-office setup (one-time)	HR pre-approval	Company-defined allowance
Internet reimbursement (remote)	Automatic for eligible roles	₹1,200/month
Purchases above ₹25,000	Manager approval mandatory	N/A

Non-Reimbursable Items

- Alcoholic beverages, except at Company-approved client events within policy limits.
- Traffic fines, parking violations, or personal entertainment.
- Upgrades to business/first class without prior Director approval.

Corporate Cards

Employees who travel frequently for client engagements may be issued a corporate card. Any personal use must be disclosed to Finance within the same billing cycle.

Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Employee	Submit itemized claims within the 15-day window
Manager	Approve claims and flag anything outside policy
Finance	Process reimbursements and audit sampled claims

Example: A remote employee submits their monthly internet bill and is reimbursed ₹1,200 automatically along with payroll.

Common Pitfalls to Avoid

- Submitting a claim after the 15-day window
- Skipping the itemized receipt for a claim
- Assuming a purchase above ₹25,000 can proceed without manager approval

07 CODE OF CONDUCT

The standard of behavior we hold ourselves to

Every person representing DataSync — in the office, remotely, at a client site, or at a Company event — is expected to act with honesty, professionalism, and respect for others.

Core Expectations

- Treat colleagues, customers, and partners with courtesy and respect, regardless of role or seniority.
- Communicate honestly with customers about product capabilities, timelines, and limitations.
- Avoid conflicts of interest, or disclose them promptly when unavoidable (Section 19).
- Protect confidential Company and customer information at all times (Section 8).
- Comply with all applicable laws, including anti-bribery, export control, and competition law.

Professional Communication

DataSync expects all written and verbal communication to remain professional even under deadline pressure or disagreement. Personal attacks or public shaming of colleagues are not acceptable.

Gifts & Hospitality

Employees may accept or offer modest business gifts and hospitality that would not reasonably be seen as an attempt to influence a business decision. Gifts above nominal value must be reported to and approved by a manager before being accepted.

Reporting Violations

Employees who witness or suspect a violation of this Code should raise it with their manager, HR Business Partner, or through the anonymous Ethics Hotline. Retaliation against anyone who raises a concern in good faith is strictly prohibited.

Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Employee	Exercise sound judgment in daily interactions
Manager	Model and reinforce professional behavior
Ethics Hotline	Receive and route good-faith concerns confidentially

Example: An employee declines a vendor's high-value gift and reports the offer to their manager, in line with the gifts and hospitality rule.

Common Pitfalls to Avoid

- Treating a small gift as automatically acceptable without reporting it
- Assuming informal chat channels are exempt from professional conduct standards
- Waiting to report a concern out of fear of retaliation

08 INFORMATION SECURITY

Protecting Company, customer, and personal data

Information security is a shared responsibility. Every employee, regardless of role, is a control point in DataSync's overall security posture.

KEY FACT Any suspected security incident — phishing, malware, unauthorized access, lost device, or accidental data exposure — must be reported to Security within 24 hours of discovery, no exceptions.

Account & Access Security

- Use the Company Single Sign-On (SSO) and multi-factor authentication (MFA) for all business systems.
- Never share passwords, access tokens, or MFA codes with anyone, including colleagues or IT support staff.
- Lock devices when stepping away, even briefly, in shared or public spaces.

Acceptable Data Handling

Access to systems and data is granted on a least-privilege, need-to-know basis. Employees must not attempt to access data, repositories, or systems outside the scope of their role, even if technically possible.

Incident Reporting

Incidents must be reported to security@datasync-tech.example via the "Report Incident" button in the email client within the 24-hour window above. Early reporting, even of a suspected false alarm, is always the right call.

Third-Party & Vendor Tools

Employees may not connect new third-party software, browser extensions, or SaaS tools to Company data without review and approval by IT Security, regardless of whether the tool is free.

Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Employee	Follow least-privilege access and MFA requirements
IT Security	Monitor systems and respond to reported incidents
Manager	Ensure their team completes required security training

Example: An employee notices a suspicious login alert on a Friday evening and reports it within the 24-hour window rather than waiting until Monday.

Common Pitfalls to Avoid

- Sharing a password or MFA code with a colleague under time pressure
- Delaying incident reporting beyond the 24-hour window
- Connecting an unapproved browser extension to Company accounts

09 DATA CLASSIFICATION

How we label and handle information based on sensitivity

DataSync classifies all data it creates, processes, or stores into one of four tiers. Correct classification determines storage location, sharing rules, retention, and which tools — including AI tools — may be used with the data.

Tier	Description	Examples	Handling Rule
Public	Approved for external release	Marketing content, blog posts	May be shared freely
Internal	For employees only	Wikis, org charts, roadmaps	No external sharing without approval
Confidential	Sensitive business/customer info	Contracts, financials, customer data	Need-to-know; approved systems only
Restricted	Highest sensitivity, regulated data	PII, health data, credentials	Encrypted, access-logged, minimal retention

Labeling Requirement

Documents containing Confidential or Restricted information must be labeled as such and stored only in approved Company systems, never in personal cloud storage or personal email.

Classification and AI Tools

Data classification directly governs what may be pasted into, uploaded to, or connected with any generative AI tool, including the Company's own retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) systems. Restricted data may only be used with AI tools explicitly approved for that data tier.

Reclassification

Data classification is not permanent. A dataset may be reclassified by the data owner in consultation with Security, and must be documented in the Data Inventory.

Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Employee	Label documents correctly at the point of creation
Data Governance	Maintain the Data Inventory and classification guidance
Engineering	Enforce classification-aware access controls in systems

Example: A customer contract is labeled Confidential and stored only in the approved document management platform, never in personal cloud storage.

Common Pitfalls to Avoid

- Storing a Confidential file in personal cloud storage for convenience
- Leaving a document unlabeled because classification feels obvious
- Forgetting to reclassify data once a contract or project ends

10 DATA PRIVACY

Respecting personal data belonging to employees, customers, and users

DataSync collects and processes personal data about employees, job applicants, customers, and end users of customer products. We are committed to handling this data lawfully, transparently, and only for disclosed purposes.

Guiding Principles

- Lawfulness, fairness, and transparency in all data processing.
- Purpose limitation — data is used only for the purpose it was collected for.
- Data minimization — collect only what is necessary.
- Storage limitation — data is retained only as long as necessary.

Applicable Regulations

Depending on the location of the data subject, DataSync's processing activities may be governed by regulations such as the GDPR, India's Digital Personal Data Protection Act, the CCPA/CPRA, and equivalent frameworks elsewhere. Legal and Data Governance maintain jurisdiction-specific guidance.

Data Subject Rights

Requests received by any employee (e.g., "please delete my data") must be forwarded to privacy@datasync-tech.example within 24 hours; do not attempt to fulfill such a request informally.

Privacy by Design

Any new product feature, internal tool, or AI system that processes personal data must undergo a Privacy Impact Assessment (PIA) before launch, especially systems that use customer or employee data to train or ground (via retrieval) a generative AI model.

Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Employee	Forward any data-subject request to Privacy within 24 hours
Legal	Interpret applicable privacy regulation for each jurisdiction
Product/Engineering	Complete a Privacy Impact Assessment before launching data-processing features

Example: A customer emails asking to delete their account data; the employee forwards the request to privacy@datasync-tech.example the same day.

Common Pitfalls to Avoid

- Trying to resolve a data-subject request informally instead of routing it to Privacy
- Assuming privacy rules are the same in every country
- Skipping a Privacy Impact Assessment for a new AI feature

11 GENERATIVE AI USAGE POLICY

How employees may use AI assistants, chatbots, and RAG systems

Generative AI tools — including large language model assistants, coding copilots, and internal retrieval-augmented generation (RAG) systems — are a standard part of how DataSync employees work.

Approved Tools

Employees may use only AI tools listed on the Approved AI Tools Registry, which currently includes the Company's internal RAG-based knowledge assistant ("DataSync Assist"), an approved enterprise chat assistant, and specific coding assistants. Use of any other AI tool for Company work requires a documented risk review before use.

Data Input Rules

- Never input Restricted-tier data into any AI tool that has not been explicitly approved for that data tier.
- Never input customer Confidential data into a public/consumer AI tool, even for a seemingly harmless task.
- Internal-tier data may be used with Company-approved enterprise AI tools that have contractual no-training/no-retention terms.

Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) Systems

DataSync Assist answers questions by retrieving from an indexed corpus of internal documents and generating a response grounded in that retrieved content. Employees should treat AI-generated answers as a drafting aid, not a final authority, and verify important facts against the underlying cited source.

- Report an answer that appears to hallucinate, misquote, or cite the wrong document via the in-app feedback control.
- Ensure documents uploaded to a RAG knowledge base are correctly classified (Section 9) and that the uploader is authorized to share the content.

Disclosure of AI-Generated Content

Any customer-facing deliverable substantially drafted by a generative AI tool must be reviewed and edited by a qualified employee before delivery; that employee remains fully accountable for its accuracy.

Prohibited Uses

- Using AI tools to generate content that impersonates a real person without consent.
- Using AI tools to bypass Company security controls or probe production systems without authorization.
- Feeding customer personal data into any AI tool for a purpose not covered by the customer contract.

Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Employee	Use only Approved AI Tools for Company work
IT Security	Maintain and publish the Approved AI Tools Registry
AI Governance Board	Review new AI use cases and data-tier approvals

Example: An analyst drafting a client report uses DataSync Assist to summarize internal research, then verifies each cited figure against the source document before sending it.

Common Pitfalls to Avoid

- Pasting Confidential data into a public AI chatbot to save time
- Treating an AI-generated answer as verified without checking the source
- Using an unapproved AI tool because it's free

12 AI DEVELOPMENT STANDARDS

Engineering standards for teams that build AI and RAG systems

Teams that design, build, fine-tune, or operate AI systems — including customer-facing products and internal tools such as RAG pipelines — must follow the standards in this section in addition to general engineering practices.

Data Sourcing & Rights

- Confirm the Company has the legal right to use any dataset for training, fine-tuning, or retrieval indexing before it enters a pipeline.
- Maintain a data lineage record for every training or retrieval corpus.
- Exclude Restricted-tier personal data from training corpora unless a documented legal basis and Privacy Impact Assessment approve it.

Model & Pipeline Evaluation

- Every model or RAG pipeline promoted to production must pass an evaluation suite covering accuracy, groundedness, and safety/harmful-content checks.

- Maintain a versioned eval report for each release; do not ship a regression without documented sign-off from the AI Governance Board.
- Red-team new customer-facing AI features for prompt injection, data exfiltration via retrieval, and jailbreak resistance before launch.

RAG Engineering Standards

- Index only documents that are correctly classified and current; stale documents must be removed on a defined refresh cycle.
- Retrieval systems serving multiple customers or teams must enforce access-control-aware retrieval.
- Log retrieved source documents alongside generated answers to support citation and audit requirements.

AI Governance Board

The AI Governance Board, comprising representatives from Engineering, Legal, Security, and Product, meets monthly to review new AI use cases, incidents, and material changes to existing systems.

Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Engineer	Follow evaluation, logging, and red-teaming requirements before release
AI Governance Board	Approve production changes that affect a system's risk classification
Security	Red-team new AI features for prompt injection and data exfiltration

Example: Before launching a new RAG feature, the team runs the evaluation suite, documents groundedness scores, and gets AI Governance Board sign-off.

Common Pitfalls to Avoid

- Skipping the evaluation suite before a production release
- Indexing stale documents into a RAG corpus
- Ignoring access-control checks in a multi-customer retrieval system

13 ACCEPTABLE TECHNOLOGY USAGE

General rules for Company devices, networks, and software

This section covers day-to-day use of Company-provided technology, complementing Sections 8 and 11.

Company Devices

- Company laptops and phones are provided for business use, with limited, reasonable personal use permitted.
- Do not install unlicensed or unapproved software; use the Company Software Catalog to request new tools.
- Keep operating systems, browsers, and endpoint security agents updated at all times.

Internet & Email Use

Company networks and email systems are provided for business purposes and are monitored for security and compliance in line with applicable law.

Bring Your Own Device (BYOD)

Where a role permits accessing Company email or chat from a personal mobile device, the device must be enrolled in the Mobile Device Management (MDM) system.

Social Media & Public Communication

Employees may identify as working at DataSync on personal social media but must not represent personal opinions as the Company's official position, and must not share Confidential or Restricted information.

Open Source & Third-Party Code

Engineers may use open-source libraries approved through the Open Source Compliance process, which checks license compatibility before a dependency is added to a Company codebase.

Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Employee	Request new software through the Company Software Catalog
IT	Approve, provision, and monitor device and account usage
Manager	Approve exceptions such as BYOD access where appropriate

Example: An employee wants to use a personal phone for Company email and enrolls it in the MDM system before access is granted.

Common Pitfalls to Avoid

- Installing unapproved software to work around a limitation
- Leaving a device unlocked in a shared space
- Using a personal device for Company email without MDM enrollment

14 PERFORMANCE REVIEWS

How we set goals, give feedback, and evaluate performance

DataSync runs a structured performance management cycle, supplemented by ongoing informal feedback between managers and their reports.

KEY FACT Formal performance reviews are conducted twice a year, in June and December, aligned with goal-setting and compensation cycles.

The Performance Cycle

Stage	Timing	Purpose
Goal Setting	Start of cycle (Jan / Jul)	Agree individual goals aligned to team objectives
Review Period	June and December	Formal rating and calibration

Stage	Timing	Purpose
Self-Assessment	Before review month	Employee reflects on achievements and growth areas
Calibration	Post-assessment	Cross-team consistency review by leadership
Review Conversation	June / December	Manager shares final rating and development plan

Rating Scale

Performance is rated on a five-point scale ranging from "Significantly Exceeds Expectations" to "Below Expectations." Ratings inform compensation review, promotion eligibility (Section 16), and, where relevant, a Performance Improvement Plan (Section 20).

Disagreeing with a Rating

An employee who disagrees with their performance rating may request a review meeting with their manager and HR Business Partner within 10 working days of receiving the rating.

Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Employee	Complete self-assessment ahead of each review
Manager	Deliver a fair, evidence-based rating
HR	Facilitate calibration across teams

Example: A manager submits ratings for their team ahead of the December review cycle, referencing specific project outcomes for each person.

Common Pitfalls to Avoid

- Waiting until the review month to raise a concern about goals
- Submitting a self-assessment without concrete examples
- Assuming a rating cannot be discussed further

15 LEARNING & DEVELOPMENT

Growing skills, certifications, and careers

DataSync invests in continuous learning because the technology we build — especially in the AI and data space — evolves quickly.

KEY FACT Every employee receives an annual learning reimbursement of up to ₹8,000, usable for courses, books, and conference tickets, subject to manager approval.

Learning Benefits

- Annual learning reimbursement of ₹8,000, per the fact above.
- Unlimited access to the Company's enterprise subscription to major online learning platforms.
- Reimbursement for one job-relevant professional certification per year.

- Internal "Guild" communities of practice that run monthly knowledge-sharing sessions.

Structured Programs

New managers complete the Manager Foundations program within their first 90 days in a people-management role. Engineers working on AI or RAG systems are encouraged to complete the internal "Responsible AI Engineering" course within their first quarter on such a team.

Mentorship

Employees may opt into the Company mentorship program, which pairs mentees with senior employees outside their direct reporting line for career guidance.

Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Employee	Use the annual learning reimbursement proactively
Manager	Approve relevant courses and conference attendance
L&D	Curate the learning platform catalog and Guild sessions

Example: An employee spends ₹6,500 of their ₹8,000 annual learning reimbursement on a data-engineering certification, with the remainder held for a later course.

Common Pitfalls to Avoid

- Letting the annual learning reimbursement go unused
- Choosing a course unrelated to the current role without discussion
- Skipping the certification exam reimbursement request window

16 PROMOTION POLICY

How advancement decisions are made

Promotions at DataSync recognize sustained performance at the next level of scope, complexity, or leadership, not simply tenure.

Promotion Cycle

Promotions are formally considered twice a year, aligned with the June and December performance review cycle described in Section 14. Off-cycle promotions may occur in exceptional cases with approval from the function head and HR.

Criteria

- Consistent performance at or above expectations for at least two consecutive review cycles.
- Demonstrated impact at the scope of the target level.
- Manager nomination, supported by concrete examples and, where applicable, peer feedback.

Process

A manager nominates an employee for promotion by submitting a promotion packet to the calibration committee for their function. Employees who are not promoted receive specific, actionable feedback on the gap to the next level.

Compensation upon Promotion

Promotions are typically accompanied by a salary adjustment aligned to the new level's compensation band, effective from the start of the following pay cycle.

Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Employee	Discuss career goals with their manager ahead of the cycle
Manager	Nominate ready employees with supporting evidence
Calibration Committee	Ensure consistency of promotion decisions across teams

Example: A senior engineer who has led two major releases is nominated for promotion ahead of the June cycle, with peer feedback included in the packet.

Common Pitfalls to Avoid

- Assuming tenure alone justifies a promotion
- Submitting a promotion packet without concrete impact examples
- Expecting an off-cycle promotion as the default path

17 GRIEVANCE PROCEDURE

Raising and resolving workplace concerns

DataSync encourages employees to raise concerns early, whether about a specific incident, a policy, or a pattern of behavior, so issues can be resolved fairly and promptly.

Formal Grievance Process

Step	Action	Timeline
1. Submission	Employee submits grievance in writing to HR	N/A
2. Acknowledgment	HR acknowledges receipt	Within 2 working days
3. Investigation	HR gathers facts	Within 15 working days
4. Outcome	HR communicates outcome and any action taken	Within 5 working days
5. Appeal	Employee may appeal outcome in writing	Within 10 working days

Confidentiality

Grievances are handled with as much confidentiality as is consistent with a fair and thorough investigation.

Non-Retaliation

DataSync strictly prohibits retaliation against anyone who raises a grievance in good faith, participates in an investigation, or supports a colleague in doing so.

Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Employee	Raise concerns early, informally where possible
HR	Investigate formal grievances within defined timelines
Manager	Support resolution without retaliating against the employee

Example: An employee raises a concern about an unfair task allocation directly with their manager, and it is resolved without needing a formal grievance.

Common Pitfalls to Avoid

- Escalating straight to a formal grievance without attempting informal resolution where appropriate
- Assuming a grievance will remain entirely secret from everyone involved
- Retaliating, even subtly, against someone who raised a concern

18 ANTI-HARASSMENT POLICY

A workplace free from harassment and discrimination

DataSync is committed to a workplace free from harassment, discrimination, and bullying, whether based on gender, race, religion, disability, age, sexual orientation, or any other protected characteristic under applicable law.

What Constitutes Harassment

- Unwelcome physical, verbal, or visual conduct that creates an intimidating, hostile, or offensive work environment.
- Sexual harassment, including unwelcome advances or comments of a sexual nature.
- Discriminatory jokes, slurs, or comments about a protected characteristic.
- Bullying, including repeated belittling, public humiliation, or exclusion.

Reporting Channels

Employees who experience or witness harassment may report it to their manager, HR Business Partner, any member of the Internal Committee, or through the anonymous Ethics Hotline.

Investigation & Outcome

All harassment complaints are investigated promptly, fairly, and confidentially. Consequences range from a formal warning to immediate termination, depending on severity, in line with Section 20.

Training

All employees complete mandatory Anti-Harassment training within 30 days of joining and on an annual refresher basis.

Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Employee	Report harassment through any available channel
Internal Committee	Investigate complaints under applicable law
HR	Ensure timely, confidential handling of every complaint

Example: An employee reports an uncomfortable comment from a colleague to HR, and the matter is investigated confidentially within the defined timeline.

Common Pitfalls to Avoid

- Dismissing a concern as "just a joke"
- Assuming harassment only happens in person
- Failing to complete the mandatory annual refresher training

19 CONFLICT OF INTEREST

Identifying, disclosing, and managing competing interests

A conflict of interest arises when an employee's personal interests could reasonably be seen to influence, or actually influence, their professional judgment on behalf of DataSync.

Common Conflict Scenarios

- Having a financial stake in a Company vendor, competitor, or customer.
- Hiring, managing, or awarding business to a close family member or friend without disclosure.
- Engaging in outside employment that competes with, or uses confidential Company knowledge for, another business.

Disclosure Requirement

Employees must disclose any actual or potential conflict of interest to their manager and HR as soon as it arises, using the Conflict of Interest Disclosure Form.

Outside Employment

Employees may take on outside work provided it does not compete with DataSync, does not use Company resources or confidential information, and does not impair the employee's ability to perform their role.

Annual Attestation

All employees complete an annual Conflict of Interest attestation confirming any relevant disclosures are current.

Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Employee	Disclose potential conflicts as soon as they arise

Role	Responsibility
Manager	Recuse themselves or the employee from affected decisions
HR/Legal	Review disclosures and approve appropriate management plans

Example: An employee whose spouse works at a prospective vendor discloses the relationship before the vendor selection decision is made.

Common Pitfalls to Avoid

- Failing to disclose a conflict because it feels minor
- Assuming disclosure automatically means the activity is banned
- Forgetting the annual attestation

20 DISCIPLINARY PROCESS

How policy violations and performance issues are addressed

DataSync follows a fair, consistent, and documented process when addressing conduct or performance concerns.

Standard Progression

Stage	Description	Typical Trigger
Verbal Counseling	Informal conversation, documented in HR notes	First, minor issue
Written Warning	Formal written warning with expectations	Repeated or moderate issue
Final Written Warning	Last formal step before separation	Continued issue after warning
Performance Improvement Plan	Structured plan with defined goals and timeline	Sustained performance shortfall
Termination	Employment ends	Failure to improve, or serious misconduct

Immediate/Serious Misconduct

Certain conduct — including harassment, fraud, theft, or willful security violations — may warrant suspension pending investigation and, if substantiated, termination without progressing through the earlier stages.

Employee Rights in the Process

- The right to understand the specific concern being raised.
- The right to respond and provide context before a final decision is made.
- The right to be accompanied by an HR representative in formal disciplinary meetings.

Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Employee	Understand expectations at each stage of the process

Role	Responsibility
Manager	Document concerns and conversations accurately
HR	Ensure consistency and fairness across similar cases

Example: After a final written warning for repeated late delivery, an employee is placed on a Performance Improvement Plan with clear 60-day goals.

Common Pitfalls to Avoid

- Skipping documentation of an informal counseling conversation
- Assuming every issue must start with a final warning
- Treating a Performance Improvement Plan as a formality rather than a genuine opportunity to improve

21 RESIGNATION & EXIT

Notice periods, knowledge transfer, and offboarding

Employees who decide to leave DataSync are asked to resign in writing to their manager and HR, stating their intended last working day, no less than the notice period specified in their employment contract.

Standard Notice Periods

Level	Notice Period
Individual Contributor	30 days
Manager / Team Lead	60 days
Director and above	90 days

Exit Process

- HR schedules an exit interview to gather feedback on the employee's experience.
- The employee and manager jointly complete a knowledge transfer plan.
- IT revokes system access and disables accounts effective the last working day.
- Company assets are returned per Section 22 before the final settlement is processed.

Rehire Eligibility

Employees who leave in good standing are generally eligible for rehire. Employees terminated for cause are typically not eligible for rehire.

Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Employee	Provide written notice per their contractual notice period
Manager	Coordinate knowledge transfer before the last working day
IT/HR	Complete offboarding checklist and final settlement

Example: A team lead submits 60 days' notice and works with their manager to document ownership of ongoing projects before departure.

Common Pitfalls to Avoid

- Giving verbal-only resignation notice
- Leaving without completing a knowledge transfer plan
- Assuming final settlement is unaffected by outstanding Company assets

22 COMPANY ASSET POLICY

Issuance, use, and return of Company property

Company assets — including laptops, mobile devices, access badges, and software licenses — remain the property of DataSync at all times and are issued solely to support the employee's work.

KEY FACT Any purchase of Company assets above ₹25,000 in value requires prior manager approval and must be logged in the IT Asset Management system before procurement.

Issuance

Assets are issued through the IT Asset Management system, which records the serial number, issue date, and employee acknowledgment of responsibility.

Use of Assets

- Company laptops must not be shared with family members or used to install unlicensed software.
- Software licenses assigned to an individual may not be shared with colleagues without a corresponding license.

Loss or Damage

Loss, theft, or damage to a Company asset must be reported to IT within 24 hours. Repeated loss or damage due to employee negligence may result in a portion of the replacement cost being recovered from the employee.

Return of Assets on Exit

All Company assets must be returned in good working condition on or before the employee's last working day. Final settlement may be delayed pending the return of outstanding assets.

Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Employee	Take reasonable care of issued assets
IT	Track issuance and recovery of all Company assets
Manager	Approve purchases above ₹25,000 before procurement

Example: A team requesting a ₹40,000 monitor upgrade for a designer routes the purchase through manager approval before it is ordered.

Common Pitfalls to Avoid

- Letting a family member use a Company laptop

- Delaying reporting of a lost or damaged asset
- Assuming a purchase under ₹25,000 needs no record at all

23 POLICY EXCEPTIONS

When and how a policy exception may be granted

This Handbook is designed to cover the vast majority of situations DataSync employees encounter. Occasionally, a business need may justify a documented, time-bound exception to a specific policy.

Requesting an Exception

An employee or manager seeking an exception must submit a Policy Exception Request through the HR portal, describing the specific policy, the business justification, and the scope and duration requested.

Approval Authority

Policy Area	Approval Required
Working Hours / Leave	Function Head + HR
Information Security / Data Classification	Chief Information Security Officer
Generative AI Usage / AI Development Standards	AI Governance Board
Expense Reimbursement	Finance Director
Code of Conduct / Anti-Harassment	Chief HR Officer + Legal

Documentation & Review

Approved exceptions are logged in the Policy Exception Register, including the approver, scope, and expiry date. Exceptions are time-bound by default and must be re-justified on expiry.

Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Employee/Manager	Submit a documented exception request when policy doesn't fit a situation
Approving Authority	Grant or deny time-bound exceptions per the approval matrix
HR	Maintain the Policy Exception Register

Example: A team requests a temporary exception to the 3-day remote-work cap during an office renovation, approved for 60 days by the Function Head.

Common Pitfalls to Avoid

- Assuming any manager can grant a policy exception informally
- Treating an approved exception as permanent
- Skipping documentation in the Policy Exception Register

24 FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

Quick answers to common questions about this Handbook

Q: Where can I find the most current version of this Handbook?

A: The authoritative version is always the one published on the internal HR portal.

Q: How many days a week can I work remotely?

A: Up to 3 days per week once you have completed probation, per Section 3.

Q: What is the internet reimbursement amount for remote employees?

A: ₹1,200 per month, credited automatically with payroll, per Section 6.

Q: How much can I claim for learning and certifications each year?

A: Up to ₹8,000 per year, per Section 15.

Q: When are performance reviews conducted?

A: Twice a year, in June and December, per Section 14.

Q: By when must I submit an expense claim?

A: Within 15 days of incurring the expense, per Section 6.

Q: Do I need approval for a large purchase?

A: Yes — any purchase above ₹25,000 requires prior manager approval, per Sections 6 and 22.

Q: I suspect a security incident. What should I do?

A: Report it to Security within 24 hours via the "Report Incident" button, per Section 8.

Q: What are the core collaboration hours?

A: 10:00 AM – 4:00 PM IST, per Section 2.

Q: Who maintains this Handbook?

A: People Operations owns the Handbook, in partnership with Legal, Security, and the AI Governance Board.

Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Employee	Check this FAQ before raising a routine question
HR/Security/Legal	Keep answers current as policies change
People Operations	Expand the FAQ based on real employee questions

Example: A new employee unsure about the internet reimbursement amount checks this FAQ and confirms it is ₹1,200 per month before submitting a claim.

Common Pitfalls to Avoid

- Assuming this FAQ replaces reading the full relevant section
- Using an old cached answer instead of checking the HR portal
- Not raising a genuinely new question to HR because it isn't listed here